

Tiny Experiments

~ Anne-Laure Le Cunff

1. Don't let anyone rob you of your imagination, your creativity or your curiosity. It's your place in the world; it's your life. Go on & do all you can with it, & make it the life you want to live.
2. Life → made of cycles of being lost & finding oneself again
3. Not having a clear playbook to follow opened a world of possibility. "This time I didn't had the big plan, just wanted to explore, learn & grow"
4. "Didn't want to let curiosity to stop flowing."
5. "What experiments could I run on my own life that would bring me an intrinsic sense of fulfillment, whatever the outcome?"
6. "Personal experimentation: living life the experimental way."
7. I'm playing a difficult game: a game of noticing, questioning & adapting.
8. Ask big ques & design tiny exp to find answer.
9. When you lean into your curiosity, uncertainty can be a state of expanded possibility, a space for metamorphosis.

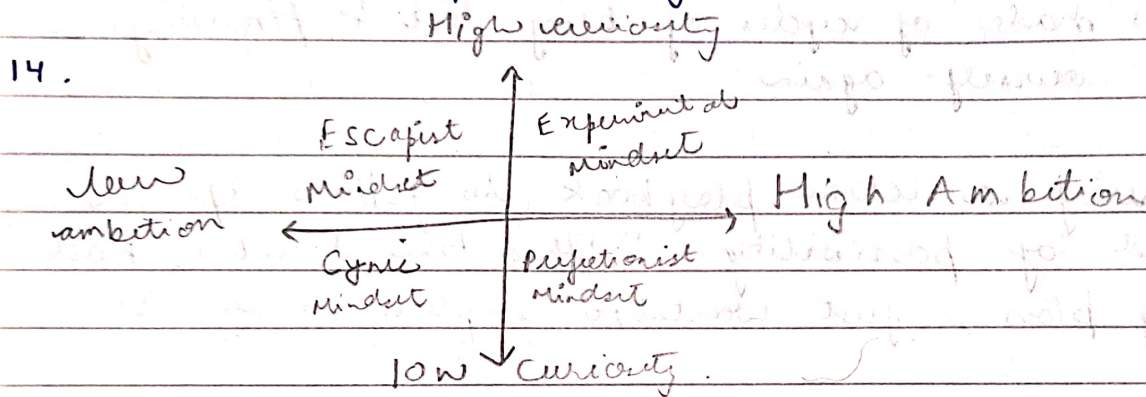
liking to experiment → to try new things.

10. Consider adventure to be worthwhile in itself.

11. Children → by failing fast & often, they learn from every experience to propel themselves forward.

12. Our goals mimic the goals of others.

13. "The most difficult thing is the decision to act."



15. Instead of needing to control the outcome, we can experiment & play.

16. Transform success from a fixed target to an unfolding path by having process based defⁿ of success not outcome based.

17. On focusing on our purpose → we only limit our potential for growth & learning.

18. Success begets success

19. Life → continuous opportunity, we each have within us unlimited possibilities, purpose is therefore never a singular discovery.

20. When we fixate on finding 1 singular purpose, we rule out the side quests that helps us grow the most
21. Your life doesn't need to follow predictable acts & arcs. The best stories are full of surprise, with colorful characters & unexpected plot twists.
22. We tend to feel more confident when we act in ways that align with societal expectation as action will be validated & reinforced by others around us.
23. Self consistency fallacy: The assumption "I have always acted in a certain way; therefore, I must continue to act in this way"
24. Unless you live in complete isolation, you'll inevitably experience pressure from those around you to conform to established defⁿ of success.
25. Linear goal → focus more on the target than on the journey.
26. The no 1 barrier to self renewal is not lack of time or lack of money; it's not knowing how to begin. ALL IT TAKES IS THE COURAGE TO BE CURIOUS.
27. The difficulty lies not in the new ideas but in escaping the old ones.
28. Use curiosity → as compass, become active observer & discover interesting paths in your life.

29. Observation / Question / Hypothesis for field notes

30. Attempt to reach a fixed destination X
Testing a hypothesis → opportunity for growth.

31. Turn your life into a giant laboratory for self discovery.

32. Design TE - "I will [action] for [duration]"

→ self invitation to try something new & learn from the experience

↳ There is no bad result as every choice.
You just need to show up.

33. P - Purposeful
A - Actionable
C - Continuous
T - Trackable

} emphasizes doing our planning
→ has specific no of trials.
→ mini protocol for personal experimentation

34. "Action seems to follow feeling, but really action & feelings go together by regulating the action we can indirectly regulate the feeling."

35. Confidence → isn't quality we are born with or something that magically happens; it's built through Actions.

36. Repeated Trials are essential features of experiments.
A good exp requires multiple trials to confirm that the results are not just due to chance.

Longer the post → more likely you to quit.

37. Most reliable way to be successful - is to try, fail, learn and try again.
38. Put in more reps - more trials to learn from mistake.
39. The value of PACT lies not in its length but in the insights & growth it brings.
40. Effort Paradox - Human Mind has a love/hate relationship with effort. We are drawn to idea of it, yet we'd rather not put the actual effort.
41. Success is showing up regardless the end result.
42. "I try my best not to think about numbers. Any time I do I become workaholic. I feel like this is not fun anymore. But whenever I remind that my only job is to show up, then that's what keeps me growing"
43. Think Tiny: what is the smallest version of this exp that you can run?
44. Approach life → as script of playful experimentation.
45. "I said, let me paint 20 paintings w/o trying to create a master-piece" "I was just looking for mistakes to learn from"
46. "Once you have this +ve momentum, it doesn't feel like work"

47. "Choosing what to work on is the highest leverage"
48. Response to uncertainty → Engage / Explore / Experiment.
NOT KNOWING THE DESTINATION TRIGGERS CURIOSITY
49. Mental Model of growth → cycles of exp with unpredictable outcome
50. focus on showing up rather than perfecting everything,
51. Nobody really wants to live a productive life. we want to express ourselves, connect with others & embrace the world.
52. Time → series of identical & interchangeable units X
↳ profoundly personal & fluid experience ✓
53. The value of time depends on the situation
53. Kairos → when you feel like this moment, right now, is perfect.
↳ embrace it, let go maximizing every min & instead appreciating the unique qualities of each moment that make up a life.
↳ Shift the focus from what we do with our time to how we experience each moment.
54. Making the most of your time isn't about doing more but about being more: more present, more engaged, & more attentive to the quality of our experience.

Kaizen rituals → way to see the present moment clearly.

55. Mindful productivity → focuses on the quality of the experience at hand.

56. Our efforts to get more done actually slow us down.

57. Simplest strategy to regulate your emotions is to stimulate your body's parasympathetic nervous system. All you need to do is move your body, it relieves anxiety straightaway. Even small movements such as rotating your wrists or ankles can stimulate your parasympathetic nervous system.

58. Being mindful means interrupting the autopilot mode taking time to appreciate the little things & observing how we feel at physical, cognitive & emotional level.

59. Kaizen ritual → develop your own, think about a simple action that can quickly change your mood.

eg → "I head to the kitchen & make myself a cup of tea. The process takes 5 min & allows me to disconnect long enough to head back with renewed calm".

↳ It should be something you look forward to & enjoy, not something that feels like a chore

↳ Physically → they guide you to pause & recalibrate your energy level

Cognitively → interrupt autopilot, allowing you to reenter your focus & approach task with renewed clarity

Emotionally → retreat to acknowledge your feelings, validate your experience, & reconnect with your inner self.

60. When you focus on being more - finding ways to be present & to slow down time - you can avoid burnout w/o abandoning your ambition.
61. When it comes to productivity, procrastination is Public Enemy No 1. → Negative Attitude about procrastination is self-defeating.
We have been taught to equate procrastination with being worthless.
The strongest emotion associated with procrastination is guilt, replace it with CURIOSITY.
62. Whenever you're procrastinating ask yourself whether it's coming from the head, the heart, or the hand:
- Head: "Is the task appropriate?"
 - Heart: "Is the task exciting?"
 - Hand: "Is the task doable?"
63. It'll be harder in the long run if you don't treat procrastination as a helpful signal.
64. Simply ask yourself: Is ^ethat task exciting? is a great prompt to identify what you're feeling. Open your filed notes & write down your response. The lack of excitement maybe due to fear, boredom or inhibition.
65. If problem runs deeper you may need more intropective approach → set timer for 10 min & free write about the task. Let your feeling flow w/o judgment or editing. The review → for patterns.

Shift self blame to self discovery.

Lean into those feelings with curiosity instead of self blame

66. Treat procrastination as gateway to self discovery.

67. Life is designed around embracing the beauty in simplicity, taking time to live, & relishing every bit of it.

68. Research → Those who embrace life's inherent imperfections with all its ups & downs exhibit greater mental well being.

By accepting life as an ever-changing cycle - good or bad, joyful & sad, fun & challenging - we become able to manage stress better & maintain robust mental health.

→ becomes fuel for creativity.

69. Success in → embracing intentional imperfection

70. Achieve sustainable success by focusing on what truly matters in the moment & letting go of absolute perfection.

71. Making progress requires 2 essential components: Trial & error. If you can't do both, you can't grow. Also it's imp to take in moments of reflection.

72. Pause to learn from each repetition.

73. Failure → is inherent in the process → should be embraced as a tool that directs us towards next step in self discovery.

What should I try next?

74. Metacognition → involves awareness + analysis.

- ↳ curiosity directed at your inner world - your thoughts, your emotions, your belief
- ↳ It's not just how fast he's running, but also how his shoes feel during the run

↳ Tool →

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75. The secret to designing growth loops → your ability to think about your own thinking, question your automatic responses & know your mind.

By reflecting on past you can better decide the future.

76. Not everything needs to be fixed; Not every problem needs a solution. Acknowledging 'em is enough to move on.

77. To err is human. We fall prey to miscalculations & mishaps. Any attempt to avoid mistakes altogether would be fruitless, but we can choose how we respond when they occur.

STRIVE TO MAKE GOOD MISTAKES. LEARN TO FAIL IN LOVE WITH 'EM

78. What matters is that you collected data & dedicated time for reflection throughout the experiment.

79. After every PACT

↗
→
↘

 persist
pounce
pivot.

80. The bravest thing you can do sometimes is to admit that a cause of action is no longer serving you & to bow out gracefully

Your past should evolve along with you.

Donee will disruption

81. Curious minds understand that the future holds infinite & unimaginable possibilities, including the potential to restart an abandoned experiment.
82. Remain open to cues that suggest a need for a change in your thinking. Remember the primary goal is to learn, grow & discover more about yourself & the world.
83. You need to pay attention to the right signals to steer ⁱⁿ the most advantageous direction.
84. Consider your life as would an anthropologist - with systematic curiosity.
85. As long as you are adapting, learning & growing you are winning.
86. It's almost impossible to fail when you see everything as experiment. In life of up there is no wrong choice.
87. "Instead he accepted the outcome, choosing to remain curious about the future rather than dwell on the past."
88. Fluidity to adapt change → not to resist chaos but to embrace it.
89. Life isn't about waiting for the storm to pass but learning to dance in the rain.

90. Our value isn't contingent upon perfect conditions or outcome, but on our commitment to ourselves & our journey.

91. Active acceptance → acknowledging -ve, difficult situation & dealing with it in a constructive way.
↓
associated with better mental health.

92. Cultivate a state of calm regardless of external circumstances. Only then can you analyze situations logically to determine what's within your control & what's not.

93. Label your Emo state → reduces flight / fight response.
↳ affective labelling
↳ putting feelings into words

Remove as much friction as possible b/w felt emotion & verbal expression.

94. Choose the side of acceptance rather than control

95. Finding humor in life's trickiest moments.

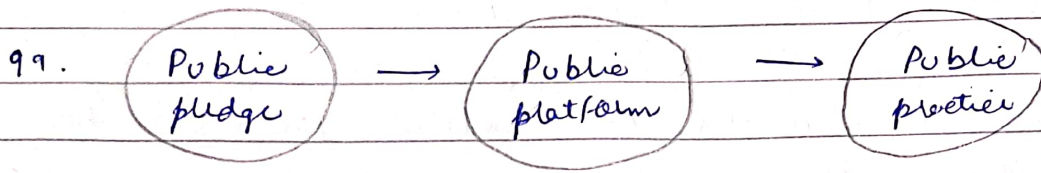
96. If it was a medical thing & you were supposed to sing / dance.

97. We are wired to function at our best when tapping into shared knowledge & support of a community.

How state happens more easily in group activities.

Embrace not having it all figured out.

98. Being a part of a community improves your mental health & happiness.



100. Just as it is in gym, start small to build confidence.

101. By nature, experiments are imperfect. They can also be a bit scary.

102. Growth often comes from struggle, frustration, confusion.

103. Flex your curiosity.

104. If you find yourself in need of final dose of courage:

In 100 yrs, you'll be dead & so will every single person in the audience. So quit worrying & get out there.

105. Generativity → principle: Not emphasizing using your personal growth to positively impact the world around you.

106. This is how you discover your life's meaning — by focusing on your daily actions rather than the content of your future eulogy.

Focus → on having fun.

107. Producing proof of work is one of the most effective ways to increase your surface area of luck.
108. Karl Jung → No matter how isolated you are & how lonely you feel, if you do your work truly and conscientiously, unknown friends will come & seek you.
109. Recognize the importance of playfulness alongside professionalism. Playfulness fosters creativity, exploration & innovation.
110. The fatal issue is that logic always gets you to exactly the same places as competitiveness.
111. Having exp → just for fun.
112. "I'll choose to shut down something if I'm not having fun."
113. The most powerful tool at your disposal is your ability to reinvent, reimagine & reshape your career journey in ways that generate value for yourself & others, as the world around you itself transforms.
114. Each experience, whether a success or failure by conventional standards, opens new doors, which you'll pass through with new capability & wisdom.
115. "What an adventure!" → is what you need to claim after five yrs.

forget the finish line & unlearn your script.



115.

Living a generative life is about embracing the adventure of not knowing where your path will lead while trusting that you will find fulfillment along the way.

116.

John Keats → Though life is fleeting & sometimes filled with darkness, the beauty to be found offers a new perpetual source of wonder to those who seek it.

117.

Your life is made for your searching - not for a predefined destination, but the joy of discovery & the satisfaction of knowing that your efforts are making a positive difference in the world.

So go forth & explore with an open mind & a generous heart.

118.

Remember that you are the chief scientist of your life. There is no universal formula. You are unique & nothing about your future is fixed.

119.

Each an opportunity to learn about the world & connect with others.

120.

Success is the lifelong experiment of discovering what makes you feel most alive.